Acme Health — Outpatient Claims Adjudication Policy

Policy document version 2. For internal adjudication use.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines the rules under which outpatient medical claims are adjudicated for Acme Health members. It applies to all outpatient services rendered by in-network and out-of-network providers. Claims for inpatient admissions are governed by a separate policy. Adjudicators must verify member eligibility on the date of service before applying the rules in this document. Where a service requires prior authorization, the authorization reference must be attached to the claim; the full list of such services is set out in Section 3.1.

Any claim that cannot be matched to a procedure code listed in Section 3.1 must be routed to manual review. Exclusions are enumerated in Section 2.2, and the appeals process is described in Section 4.

2. Coverage Rules

2.1 General Coverage Conditions

Outpatient services are covered when they are medically necessary, rendered by a licensed provider acting within the scope of their license, and billed with a procedure code listed in the reimbursement schedule. Medical necessity is presumed for preventive services with a 0% copayment in Section 3.1. For all other services, the diagnosis code on the claim must support the billed procedure. Claims submitted more than 180 days after the date of service are denied for untimely filing unless the member can demonstrate good cause, as described in Section 4. Effective with this revision, telehealth consultations are covered at parity with in-person visits.

2.2 Exclusions

The following are excluded from outpatient coverage: cosmetic procedures without reconstructive indication; experimental or investigational treatments; services rendered outside the coverage period; charges exceeding the maximum benefit amounts listed in Section 3.1; and convenience items. Denials based on this subsection may be appealed under Section 4.

3. Reimbursement

3.1 Reimbursement Schedule

The schedule below lists the maximum benefit per procedure, the member copayment percentage, and whether prior authorization is required. Amounts are in USD and apply per occurrence.

Procedure Code	Description	Max Benefit (USD)	Copay	Prior Auth
OP-1001	General practitioner consultation	45.00	10%	No
OP-1002	Specialist consultation	90.00	15%	No
OP-1003	Telehealth consultation	35.00	10%	No
OP-2001	Basic metabolic panel	28.50	0%	No
OP-2002	Complete blood count	22.00	0%	No
OP-2003	Lipid panel	31.00	0%	No
OP-2004	HbA1c test	26.00	0%	No
OP-2005	Thyroid function panel	48.00	0%	No
OP-3001	Chest X-ray (2 views)	110.00	20%	No
OP-3002	Abdominal ultrasound	165.00	20%	No
OP-3003	MRI brain without contrast	680.00	20%	No

Procedure Code	Description	Max Benefit (USD)	Copay	Prior Auth
OP-3004	MRI lumbar spine	580.00	20%	Yes
OP-3005	CT chest with contrast	450.00	20%	Yes
OP-3006	Mammogram (screening)	135.00	0%	No
OP-3007	Bone density scan (DEXA)	125.00	10%	No
OP-4001	Physical therapy session	75.00	15%	No
OP-4002	Occupational therapy session	78.00	15%	No
OP-4003	Speech therapy session	82.00	15%	Yes
OP-4004	Chiropractic adjustment	55.00	25%	No
OP-4005	Acupuncture session	60.00	25%	Yes
OP-5001	Minor wound suturing	140.00	10%	No
OP-5002	Skin lesion excision	210.00	15%	Yes
OP-5003	Joint injection (corticosteroid)	160.00	15%	No
OP-5004	Colonoscopy (screening)	720.00	0%	Yes
OP-5005	Upper GI endoscopy	680.00	15%	Yes
OP-5006	Cataract surgery (outpatient)	1850.00	20%	Yes
OP-6001	Influenza vaccination	18.00	0%	No
OP-6002	Pneumococcal vaccination	42.00	0%	No
OP-6003	Shingles vaccination	95.00	0%	No
OP-6004	Travel vaccination package	160.00	50%	No
OP-7001	Diabetic retinopathy screening	88.00	0%	No
OP-7002	Glaucoma screening	72.00	10%	No
OP-7003	Audiometry assessment	64.00	10%	No
OP-7004	Spirometry / lung function	58.00	10%	No
OP-8001	Mental health counselling (45 min)	95.00	15%	No
OP-8002	Psychiatric evaluation	180.00	15%	Yes
OP-8003	Group therapy session	40.00	10%	No
OP-9001	Dietitian consultation	70.00	20%	No
OP-9002	Smoking cessation program	120.00	0%	No
OP-9003	Cardiac rehabilitation session	105.00	10%	Yes
OP-9004	Sleep study (home-based)	310.00	20%	Yes
OP-9005	Allergy panel testing	150.00	15%	No
OP-9006	Wart / verruca removal	85.00	25%	No
OP-9007	Ear irrigation	38.00	10%	No
OP-9008	Holter monitor (24h)	190.00	20%	No
OP-9009	Continuous glucose monitor fitting	145.00	10%	No

3.2 Coordination of Benefits

Where a member holds concurrent coverage with another insurer, Acme Health pays secondary to the primary plan. The combined reimbursement must not exceed the maximum benefit listed in Section 3.1 for the billed procedure. Adjudicators must request the primary plan's explanation of benefits before finalizing any coordinated claim.

4. Appeals

A member or provider may appeal an adverse determination within 60 days of the denial notice. First-level appeals are reviewed by an adjudicator not involved in the original decision. Appeals of medical-necessity denials require review by a licensed clinician. Denials for untimely filing, per Section 2.1, are upheld unless documented good cause exists. Coverage questions arising under Section 2.2 exclusions follow the same process. Unresolved second-level appeals proceed to external review as defined in Appendix A.

Appendix A — External Review

External review is conducted by an independent review organization. The organization's determination is binding on Acme Health. Members retain any rights available under applicable law. Requests must include the final internal denial letter and supporting clinical records, as described in Section 4.